

Joel Leiva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to express my interest in the cybersecurity internship position. I am a Computer Science student at Kean University specializing in Cybersecurity, with hands-on experience in firewall configuration, network segmentation, SIEM monitoring, and infrastructure hardening. I am particularly interested in roles aligned with SOC operations or network security engineering.

Through my internship at the Center for Cybersecurity, I conduct open-source threat intelligence research analyzing ransomware campaigns, data breaches, and DoS/DDoS activity impacting nonprofit and NGO sectors. This experience strengthened my ability to assess attacker tactics and translate findings into actionable defensive insights. I also assisted in building and configuring a secure server rack environment, integrating network switching, PoE devices, and monitoring systems to support secure operations.

In the NCyTE Virtual Cybersecurity Career Challenge (VCCC), I worked within a Proxmox-hosted enterprise lab consisting of routers, firewalls, Active Directory/DNS, database, web and email servers, and client endpoints. I configured and hardened firewall rule sets to enforce segmentation across LAN, WAN, and DMZ zones, mitigating threats identified during simulated penetration testing. I also deployed and secured a Windows Server-based web server using IIS, applying security best practices while publishing a functional web application.

In my home lab, I simulate attack and defense scenarios using Ubuntu and Kali Linux virtual machines. I analyze traffic with Wireshark, perform reconnaissance with Nmap, validate suspicious files with VirusTotal, and document findings in Splunk following SOC-style workflows.

I am eager to contribute to a security team focused on proactive monitoring, threat detection, and defense-in-depth strategies. I welcome the opportunity to discuss how my technical background aligns with your organization's objectives.

Sincerely,

Joel Leiva